26. TNA/FO371/6403/E4675, Telegram from Curzon to Norman, 18 April 1921. Curzon's suspicion of Persian sincerity was not entirely unfounded; throughout the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, many Persian officials were apt to use British and Russian rivalry for their own gain, playing one off against the other, all the while increasing their own privilege and power. Nonetheless, by 1918 Persia's rulers were certainly under more pressure than ever before to avoid being seen as pandering to foreign desires. Olson, op. cit., p. 10.

27. Ibid ., p. 256.

28. TNA/FO371/6403/E4804, Telegram from Norman to the Foreign Office, 23 April 1921.

29. TNA/FO371/6401/E2379, Telegram from Norman to the Foreign Office, 21 Feb. 1921. For more on the coup see Chaqueri, Birth of a Trauma , pp. 307–326. For more on Norman's alleged involvement in the coup , and Britain's apparent support of Reza Khan's political intrigues see Zirinsky, 'Imperial Power and Dictatorship: Britain and the Rise of Reza Shah, 1921–1926', International Journal of Middle Eastern Studies , Vol. 24, No. 4 (Nov., 1992), pp. 639–63.

30. Zia'eddin was overthrown on 25 May 1921. TNA/FO371/6406/E6678, Memorandum on meeting between Oliphant and Persian Minister, 11 June 1921.

31. TNA/FO371/6404/E6678, Memorandum on meeting between Oliphant and Persian Minister, 11 June 1921.

32. TNA/FO371/6404/E6678, Minute by Curzon, 12 June 1921. While it appeared that Curzon had washed his hands entirely of Persia's internal affairs, this did not stop Norman from trying to resurrect Britain's standing in that country. The diplomat continued to try to persuade Curzon to soften his stance towards the Persian government and to abandon or amend the agreement. Indeed, in August 1920 Curzon told Norman, rather cattily, 'I think you ought to know that [the] length and frequency of your telegraphs are a source of unfavourable comment in Cabinet…it would facilitate our